

Major Indian IT Companies Found Absent at CeBIT

International trade fairs like CeBIT attract a lot of talent, technology and trade from all over the world. CeBIT holds a special place among high-tech trade fairs as it attracts and welcomes the young students and entrepreneurs besides the business honchos, especially from the field of information technology. It was marketed as the largest 'confex' (conference-cum-exhibition) of high-tech. Here is a post-show report of CeBIT 2013 held recently in Hannover, Germany, from 5th to 11th March

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Besides European companies, CeBIT 2013 attracted exhibitors and visitors in large numbers from all other continents as well. Poland was the partner country this year, with 150 of its companies spread over eight halls. Not many may know but Poland has a very strong IT sector. Out of the world's 20 top computer games, five are from Poland. Poland enjoys a very special place within the European Union.

China also had a massive presence in many of the seventeen halls where the fair was held. Some other Asian countries that registered their presence in good numbers included Taiwan, Hong Kong, Korea and Malaysia. India also registered a fairly good presence with more than twenty exhibitors and several hundred, or perhaps a few thousand, visitors.

Gaming

Two out of the seventeen halls were devoted exclusively to electronic gaming. With the bigger of the two halls taken up by Intel and its associates, CeBIT could be seen as an exciting playground for the young. Intel produces some very powerful gaming chips, which, combined with the skills of the young gaming champions, make some very heady cocktails of electronic games shows. These games were projected on huge screens behind equally huge stages. The stages were well set for mesmerising the audience, each time a game began. Acer also attracted lots of enthusiasts to its gaming terminals, which were lined up in hundreds!

Motor racing was perhaps one of the earliest electronic

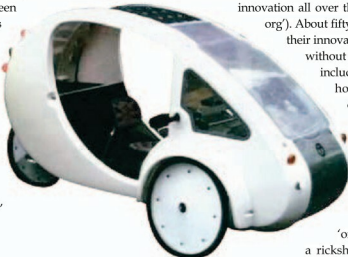
games developed. But interest in this category of games has not lessened, in spite of various other games taking the lead from time to time. The racing games could be seen in different formats at various halls. Intel, of course, takes the lead when it comes to gaming. Its two white-coloured racing cars, with visitors seated as the human drivers, was another point of attraction.

Innovations

Another attraction was CODE_n. Not many may have heard of it but it seems to be doing a wonderful job in promoting innovation all over the world (check 'www.code-n.org'). About fifty digital pioneers demonstrated their innovations in this area in open space, without boundaries. These innovations included various solutions for smart homes, making water safe for drinking, ultra-capacitors, solar-powered rickshaw-cum-car The ELF, and Volocopter that could fly you like a helicopter. Strategic partners for CODE_n were GFT, CeBIT and Ernst & Young.

The ELF is touted to be an 'organic' transport that combines a rickshaw-type tricycle and a solar-powered (60W) mini car/scooter. It can be self-driven to work using its electric motor that uses a lithium-iron phosphate battery. If you feel like exercising on the way back, you could pedal it back to your home—saving you time at the gym. The ELF has ample room for your bag and even for the groceries you may want to pick up on the way. It has 3-speed transmission, LED lights, adjustable seat, disk brakes, and side and rear mirrors. Organic Transit, developers of The ELF, said they were negotiating its manufacture in India with the help of an Indian company.

Among the other innovative products showcased at CeBIT was a sonic chair. In this chair you sit inside a big round 'loud-



Solar-powered rickshaw-cum-car, The ELF